

ISSN : 2395 -728X

Shiksha Shodh Manthan

A Half Yearly International Refereed Journal of Education

Vol.3, No.2, April 2017



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Abstract

The advent of information & technology has broken the barriers of national boundaries. Socio-economic statuses of societies are changing & also the work culture. The onus of taking up the responsibility of enabling the individuals to face the challenging situations is on education. Higher education bears the important position in preparing the technology-driven, value-drive, competent & skilled individuals. In the era of globalisation & modernisation higher education has to keep pace with the changing time. A new paradigm is evolving which consists of new trends in education system. Privatisation, distance education, collaborative education, franchising, branching campus & trans national education are the few concepts which are taking place of the traditional education system. This paper throws light on these concepts of higher education & their benefits for the development of technology & value-driven global citizens. Globalization has also created a society which is multicultural & multilingual & this in turn making the teaching-learning process more challenging. To face these challenges new trends in higher education are not enough there is a need of knowledge about Learning Styles. Knowledge of different learning styles would enable both the teachers & learners to cope with the demands of learners coming from multicultural backgrounds. This paper discusses about various learning styles which can be helpful in developing global talent & also about recent trends in higher education which would certainly provide more flexible opportunities to the learners across the world to come at one platform & learn.

Key Words: Higher Education, Globalisation, Privatisation, Franchising, Trans-national education, Learning Styles.

Introduction:

In the era of knowledge-driven economy and learning societies, both formal and informal education is playing an increasingly vital role in promoting economic solidarity, social cohesion, individual growth, sustainable development, and a culture of peace and world citizenship. Whereas our views about the way we live, learn, work, and 'think about work' have changed, the acquisition of knowledge and skills provided by a traditional formal educational setup do not correspond. Therefore, a new paradigm must evolve that is developmental, human-centred, environmentally sound, and all-inclusive, so as to prepare learners to be contributors to knowledge and not just mere recipients of knowledge. It has opened up new challenges and opportunities for higher education institutions – whether public, private, or hybrid.

In his address entitled, 'A matter of heart' delivered at the Peking University in 1990 Diasaku Ikeda, a leading peace philosopher said, "It is people who will pave the way toward the future of the world, & there is no greater influence in the development of an individual than that of solid, human-centred education. Learning is the fundamental force that builds society &

shapes an age. It nurtures & tempers the infinite potential latent in all of us & it directs our energies towards the creation of values.”

Higher education bears the onus of developing & enhancing the zone of knowledge on one hand & creating global citizens having humane approach on the other.

Given the increasingly corporate culture in higher education, it is not surprising that ‘education’ has been included as a ‘service’ or a ‘commodity’ under the General Agreement on Trade and Tariffs (GATT) and World Trade Organization (WTO). Though UNESCO has been striving hard towards protecting and strengthening higher education as a common good at the global level by promoting pluralism and diversity, on the one hand, and equitable access, capacity building, and sharing of knowledge, on the other, the GATS and WTO are striving equally hard towards reducing the barriers to ‘trade’ in higher education.

The concept of private higher education is not new. In Asia, private institutions have always been a central part of higher education. Private higher education has been playing a major role in Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, Taipei, Indonesia, and the Philippines. In these countries, up to 80 percent of students attend private institutions. Private higher education is reported to be rapidly growing in China, Vietnam, Cambodia, and other central Asian republics as well. Generally, private post-secondary institutions are found to be at the lower end in terms of prestige, though there are some high quality private universities, such as Waseda and Keio in Japan, De La Salle and the Ateneo de Manila in the Philippines, Yonsei in South Korea, and Santa Dharma in Indonesia. These universities are among the oldest in their respective countries and share a reputation of training the elite class (Altbach, 2002).

India is not far behind in adopting new trends in higher education. It is the demand of contemporary world to walk hand in hand with modern technology & moral & ethical values. As the member of global society it has become the need of the hour to move forward towards the common goal of preparing technology-friendly as well as value-driven global citizens. Higher education has already taken up this responsibility in different countries of the world but many more steps need to be taken to achieve the goal.

Higher Education: Concept and Meaning

The term Higher Education is ambiguous in nature because it is used in variety of ways by different people, different country and in different point of time. Internationally after school education can be divided into Higher Education and Further Education and is known as Tertiary Education. Higher Education qualification implies Higher Diplomas, Foundation Degrees to Honours Degrees and takes a minimum of 3 years to maximum of 4 years to complete. Further Education on the other hand refers to Post Graduate or Master and Doctorate degrees. In a single word Tertiary Education means colleges and university level education. Indian education ladder starts at 6 years of age. It comprise of 10 years of primary or elementary and secondary stages, 2 years of higher secondary stages, 3 years bachelor’s degree, 2 years of masters degree and at least 3 years beyond masters degree for a Ph.D. According to NEP 1968, 1986 this is known as 10+2+3 system. The Post Higher Secondary Education is known as Higher Education in India.

The purpose of higher education includes:

- inspire and enable individuals to develop their capabilities, so that they can grow intellectually, are well equipped for a profession or work, can contribute effectively to society and achieve personal fulfilment
- increase knowledge and understanding for their own sake as well as the application thereof to the benefit of a profession and society
- serve the needs of an adaptable, sustainable, and knowledge-based profession and the economy at local, regional and national levels
- play a major role in shaping an individual to become part of a society (Wallace 1999: 153)

Higher education must create a learning environment that affords opportunities to advance, develop and enrich individuals, both intellectually and in society (South Africa 2001). The emphasis is on learning rather than teaching (learner-centred approach) and on outcomes (what the learner becomes and understands). Higher education must work for fostering the potentials of learners to make them global talents.

Recent Trends in Indian Higher Education

The major challenge before the country is to accept the new educational ideas with retaining own education ethos. The issue of maintaining the quality of higher education institutions with absorption of increasing quantity of students is also a serious concern. The different forms of educational set-up mentioned above are contributing to deal with the challenges and making the higher education system more efficient.

India provides a big market and playing field for private initiatives at both the national and international levels. It is very rich in human resources, in terms of quantity as well as quality. India is being projected as a would-be super-power by the year 2020; at the same time, higher education, which is growing at the rate of 20% per annum worldwide, is being counted as one of the most important ingredients in knowledge-based economies. India therefore faces a big challenge in achieving its goals in this respect. Private initiatives in higher education are not only feasible, but also desirable, if India is to meet the target of 20% of its youth in the age group of 17-23, as against 7.2% today.

(a) Privatization

Privatization means initiation of private ownership, management and control of organizations. The control is in terms of decision making and responsibility of money and administration. In education privatization can be seen as expansion of private sector's control. Privatization of higher education has emerged in several forms and types in the recent decade in India. Privatization within government higher education institutions takes place in the form of introducing self-financing courses within government institutions. There are another trends such as converting government aided private institution in to private self financing institution and also allowing self financing private institution with recognition and also without recognition. This may be termed as commercial private higher education institutions. Private players are mainly

engaged themselves in setting up of state private universities, deemed university and academic institution with foreign collaboration. These private institutions have taken a quite respectable share of higher education institutions in the country in terms of quantity. When we talk about quality education the private institutions are at growing stage but they are growing at a faster pace. They are taking leading role in developing and enhancing research database & systems and also providing conducive environment for professional growth.

(b) Globalization

With the development of information and communication technology the barriers of national boundary has been broken. As a result there has been considerable development in the social, economical and educational fields at international and global level. This is termed as internationalization and globalization. The development in education has resulted in the following events.

- i. Increased practice of international comparison of educational development.
- ii. Mobility of students from one country to another.
- iii. Mobility of scholars from one country to another.
- iv. Setting up of educational institution from one country to another.
- v. Marketing of education worldwide.

Indian higher education institutions are providing the facilities to their human resources for becoming leaders of global world.

Collaborative Education

Collaborative education is an emerging concept in the Indian education system, whose basic idea is to promote the interaction and sharing of knowledge for the enhancement, creation and expansion of new knowledge. The concept of collaborative education can be seen in the following types –

- Institution-Institution Collaboration
- Institution-School Collaboration
- Institution-Community Collaboration
- Institution-NGO Collaboration
- Institution-State Collaboration
- Institution-State-NGO Collaboration
- Institution-Industry Collaboration and various other forms.

The concept of collaborative education helps in bringing the institutions closer which leads for understanding each-others functions and works and reforming their ideas. This would in turn help in fostering the global talent.

Distance Education

Distance education has been defined by the Thesaurus of descriptions as ‘education via communications media e.g. correspondence, radio, television etc. with little or no classroom or face-to-face contact between students and teachers’. Distance teaching is the family of

instructional methods in which the teaching behaviours are executed apart from the learning behaviours so that the communication between the teacher and learner must be facilitated by print, electronics, mechanical or other devices. In India this mode of education is quite popular and a number of people are getting benefitted by this.

Franchising

It is the process where a higher education institution (franchiser) from a certain country authorizes another institution (franchisee) from the same or from another country to provide it (i.e. the franchiser's) educational services (the whole or a part of one or more of its approved study programme/qualifications).

Branch Campus

A higher education institution from one country establishes its campus in another country in order to offer its own educational programmes/qualifications there. The students get enrolled there in the branch campuses with the courses offered by the institution. The arrangement is similar to franchising but the difference is that the branch campuses are owned by the institution, where as in franchise system, the institution (franchiser) only allow the other institution (franchisee) to offer its courses.

Trans-National Education

Trans-national education refers to a situation where the educational provider and the students opting for education are located in different countries. The educational discourses between the educational providers and students are carried out through multiple means, namely, mail, computer network, teleconferencing, radio or television network, etc. Transnational Education denotes any teaching or learning activity in which the students are in a different country (the host country) to that in which the institution providing the education is based (the home country). This situation requires that national boundaries be crossed by information about the education, and by staff and/or educational materials. (*Global Alliance for Trans-national Education (GATE), 1997, p. 1*)

We can see the Trans-national Education in the following forms:

- **People mobility-based education:** a person can go abroad for educational purpose.
- **Programme mobility-based education:** an educational programme can go abroad.
- **Institution mobility-based education:** an institution or provider can go or invest abroad for educational purposes.

Learning Styles

The diversity of students engaged in higher education continues to expand. Students come to colleges with varied ethnic and cultural backgrounds, from a multitude of training programs and institutions, and with differing learning styles. Coupled with this increase in diversification has been a growth in distance education programs and expansions in the types of instructional media used to deliver information. These changes and advances in technology have

led many educators to reconsider traditional, uniform instruction methods and stress the importance of considering student learning styles in the design and delivery of course content.

A benchmark definition of “learning styles” is “characteristic cognitive, effective, and psychosocial behaviours that serve as relatively stable indicators of how learners perceive, interact with, and respond to the learning environment. Learning styles are considered by many to be one factor of success in higher education.

- Many researchers have argued that knowledge of learning styles can be of use to both educators and students. Faculty members with knowledge of learning styles can tailor pedagogy so that it best coincides with learning styles exhibited by the majority of students. Alternatively, students with knowledge of their own preferences are empowered to use various techniques to enhance learning, which in turn may impact overall educational satisfaction.
- The value of the concept *learning style* is that it is learner-focused, not educator-focused.
- The educator becomes the secondary focus. Only after the focus is directed towards the learner and how he or she learns, does the emphasis shift to how the educator can use teaching styles to accommodate learner needs (Carroll 1992: 115). Extensive research done by Dunn and Dunn (1979:239) revealed that those individuals who were taught through methods that complemented their learning characteristics and preferences, expressed in learning styles, became increasingly motivated and achieved better academically. According to various researchers (Forney 1994:337; Presland 1994: 181), learning environments that match learning styles will influence variables such as self-esteem and motivation to learn positively, which will again produce successful learning experiences.
- Learning styles are not merely study skills but can be seen as higher-order cognition such as:
 - Planning
 - Monitoring
 - Checking
 - Revising
 - Self-testing

Learning styles provide the underlying process of acquisition of knowledge among learners. The educators as well as students can take the guidance from different learning styles for the proper development of global personality. Different learners learn through different ways. Learning styles provide a wide range of modes through which information processing can be done. This multimodal approach is more beneficial in this global era as students from different areas of the world come at common platforms to study.

Global trends & Learning Styles

Higher education has already taken the lead in adopting new trends in education as it has to foster global talent. But adoption of global trends is challenging the system with various issues like accommodating the learners from different areas of the world at one place, understanding their culture, knowing their comprehension skills, providing wide arena for learning & many

more. The learners are coming from different cultural backgrounds & learning environment. Therefore, it becomes important to know about multimodal learning styles to cater the needs of multicultural learners. Learning styles encourage variety in the classroom which is already filled with variety of learners in terms of their personal & academic background. Global trends in education pose different challenges before educators so they need to understand various learning styles for preparing the individuals with global vision, innovative & creative thinking, humanitarian values, feeling of cooperation & collaboration, and better emotional adjustment capacities.

Conclusion:

Though India has a long heritage of quality higher education system it has failed to solve the problems of Access, Equity, and Quality until recent past. The deteriorating administration, unproductive practice, corruption and fund availability leads to break down of indigenous educational system. Recently with the introduction LPG i.e. liberalization, privatization and globalization an avenue to revive the system has evolved. On the one hand globalization may help to improve the quality of education it can also affect the indigenous development of educational sector. A domestic regulatory mechanism should be put into place to avoid negative impact of globalization. Education is an inseparable entity of any nation. India as a nation has its educational agreements with different countries and international global bodies. Hence the structure of education in India is taking new shape in accordance with the changing scenario.

Although there is no unified conceptual description of learning styles, there is enough evidence to support a contention that such an educational entity exists at the paradigmatic level. Knowledge of learning styles provides a potentially powerful basis for educational guidance. A wealth of information is made available that can help the learner and the educator scientifically to individualise learning. This does not imply, however, that educators can no longer teach groups of learners but that individual differences can be addressed in the teaching-learning process. It has relevance for both the course of individual learning in various subject matter areas and for the nature of the learner educator interactions and social behaviour in the learning environment. Certainly the direction of higher education should be towards obtaining more detailed knowledge of the individual learning styles of the learners involved if it has to adopt global trends to develop global talent.

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How to cite reference of this paper-

Singh, V. & Awasthi, S. P. (2017). Global trends and learning styles in Indian higher education. *Shiksha Shodh Manthan*, 3(1), 26-33.